

Do I need to register for the Great Exhibition Road Festival?

Registering in advance is highly encouraged. This means you get sent the latest updates about the Festival, as well as notified when free tickets are released for popular events.

Is it free?

Yes, all events at the Great Exhibition Road Festival are free and the majority of activities are drop-in (meaning you can just turn up). Some events will have free tickets that people can get in advance, which will be released closer to the weekend. Events with advance tickets will usually also have drop-in spaces available on the day. Please check the event page for details.

Is there a map of the Festival?

You will be able to view a detailed map of the Festival closer to the weekend, outlining where different zones, performance spaces, food and drink, and other facilities are located. A sensory map will also be published.

[See a map of Festival venues.](#)

How can I get to the Festival?

Find all the information you need about [travelling to the Festival](#). This will be updated with any necessary travel information affecting the Festival weekend closer to the time.

When is the Festival and what times are events running?

The Festival is on 6-7 June 2026, with activities from 12.00-18.00.

A large amount of the Festival programme runs all day, however certain events are timed. The best way to plan what you'd like to go to is by browsing the [what's on](#) section of our website, where you will be able to filter by times and date at the top of the page.

Is there a programme available?

The Festival programme will also be emailed to everyone who has pre-registered and physical copies can be collected at the Festival from the information tents (which will be located on Exhibition Road, Imperial College Road, Kensington Gardens and in Prince's Gardens). The programme will only contain a small selection of the events happening over the 2026 Festival weekend, check the [what's on pages](#) for more event details.

How can I plan what I want to do/see?

Make sure to browse the [what's on](#) section of our website and create your own itinerary by clicking the 'heart' on these event pages. This will create a 'my favourites' page (that you can see by clicking at the top of the Festival site), which you can print or email to yourself.

Do I need to pre-book for any events?

Some popular events will have advance tickets released closer to the Festival weekend (register to be notified when these become available).

If you have an advance ticket, please arrive at the venue 10 minutes before the start time. Your ticket gives you priority access, however, as all Festival events are free we overbook to help ensure a full event and your space may be reallocated. Early arrival reduces this risk.

If you don't have a ticket for an event but would still like to go, arrive early and the Festival team will do their best to get you a space.

What is a zone?

Activities at the Festival are primarily grouped into Festival zones, packed full of interactive exhibits, creative workshops, and live demonstrations!

The zones at the 2026 Festival are:

1. [Adults Only Zone](#)
2. [Family Fun Zone](#)
3. [NextGen Zone](#)
4. [Be a Scientist Zone](#)
5. [Tech Zone](#)
6. [Happiness and Health Zone](#)
7. [World Science Zone](#)
8. [Underground Adventure Zone](#)

Our website will list some of the events happening inside these zones, but a huge amount of exciting exhibits won't be listed—so make sure you check them out on the day to discover a wide array of science and art activities!

Can I access all of the zones?

While most of the zones are open to everyone and will have activities appropriate for all ages, three zones are designed for specific age groups (the Family Fun Zone, Adults Only Zone and NextGen Zone).

The Family Fun Zone has activities for families with children aged 12 and under, the NextGen Zone is designed for young people aged 13-25, and the Adults Only Zone is strictly 18+. No one younger than 18 will be allowed access to the Adults Only Zone.

There may also be certain activities in other zones for specific age groups, these will be well sign-posted or if you're unsure ask a Festival volunteer (those wearing pink high-vis vests!)

Are there events for specific audiences (adults/young people/families)?

Yes, there are three zones designed for specific age groups (the Family Fun Zone, NextGen Zone and Adults Only Zone). There is also content outside of these zones that have designed with specific audiences in mind, like our Super Cool Chemistry Show for families.

When on the [what's on](#) section of our website, you can filter by age groups to find the events best for you.

Can I bring my pet?

There are plenty of activities in outside spaces, dogs must be kept on leads to be permitted within external spaces of Imperial College London (where most Festival activity is programmed). Only assistance dogs will be permitted in the internal spaces of the Festival.

Partner venues (like the V&A, Goethe-Institut and Natural History Museum) will have their own rules about animals, please refer to their website or ask to be signposted to relevant partner staff on the weekend to ask.

Where can I get more information on the day?

There will be information tents located on the south end of Exhibition Road, on Imperial College Road, in Kensington Gardens and in Prince's Gardens. You can also ask questions of any Festival volunteers (who will be wearing pink high-vis vests).

What accessible facilities do you provide?

Gender-neutral wheelchair-accessible toilets and baby changing facilities are located across the Festival site and in partner institutions.

A sensory and visual map of the Festival will also be released closer to the weekend.

Please visit our [Access page](#) for details on Accessibility at the Great Exhibition Road Festival, with lots of resources and further information provided.

There will also be a [Relaxed Session in the Family Fun Zone](#) on Sunday morning for families with members who are neurodiverse (for example, people with autism spectrum conditions or sensory processing difficulties) who may need a quieter, less busy environment with fewer crowds to enjoy the activities taking place!

New for 2026, we will also have a [Relaxed Session in the Adults Only Zone](#) on Sunday at 12 noon for adults who might need a calmer environment to explore our Adults Only Zone.

Are multi-faith spaces available at the Festival?

Yes, there will be a multi-faith spaces at the Festival. These are located in Seminar rooms 1, 2 and 3 inside Imperial College London's Business School (World Science Zone).

In each room there are prayer mats that can be used, with toilets and a water fountain located nearby.

What Food and Drink is available?

We will have an array of artisan producers, tasty street food vendors and delicious, sweet stalls for everyone to enjoy. From local specialities to chef's specials, you'll find tonnes of treats with plenty of vegetarian and vegan options available! [Click here to see the 2026 food and drink traders](#)

There will also be access to drinking water across the Festival, in:

- Dangoor Plaza – outside the Queen's Tower Rooms

- Prince's Gardens – on the corner of East Side
- Imperial College Road next to the Queen's Tower
- Lower ground floor foyer of Imperial Business School
- Partner venues like the V&A, Natural History Museum, and Science Museum have water fountains and water at their cafes
- Kensington Gardens at the top of Exhibition Road

Is there a buggy park available?

Yes, you can access a few buggy parks at the Great Exhibition Road Festival. Please check back nearer the time to see the exact locations.

Can children be left unattended at activities in the Festival?

Children must be accompanied by an adult at all activities. The Festival can get busy so please keep a close eye on children.

Will there be security at the Festival?

Yes, security will be patrolling along Exhibition Road, Imperial College Road, Kensington Gardens, Prince's Gardens and in the main internal zones on the Imperial College London campus. All security are highly visible.

What if it rains? Will the Festival be cancelled?

No! Many activities are hosted in indoor zones, and if it does rain, alternatives for some Festival activities will be found. Visitors should check with the Information Tent for updates or look out for signage in case any events have been located.

We would only cease Festival activity if the weather is extreme. And while certain spaces (like performance stages) may be affected by wet weather, we will do our best to find alternatives and communicate them with visitors.

Is there Public Wi-Fi available?

Yes. Free Wi-Fi is available throughout Imperial College London's campus via Sky WIFI. Connect to The Cloud from the available network list, open a browser and follow the simple one-time registration process. Once registered the connection is automatic.